

Gabon

Ratio: 3:4 **Adopted:** August 9, 1960 **Usage:** National and Civil

Yellow and green represent natural resources



Blue represents the sea

Africa



Gabon was once a province of French Equatorial Africa. It became independent in 1960 under the leadership of the Gabon Democratic Party.

The original flag was adopted in 1959 and was similar to the present one, but with stripes of unequal width and the French *Tricolore* in the canton. The *Tricolore* was dropped at independence. The flag's unusual proportions are laid down by law and the colors are said to stand for the sea, and for the country's natural

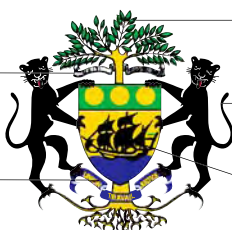
resources, especially its timber.

The coat of arms is of European style and is in the colors of the flag. The shield is supported by two black panthers and an *okoumé* tree, symbolic of the timber trade. The coat of arms is unusual in having a Latin motto—"Uniti Progrediamur," beneath the branches of the tree.

ARMS OF GABON

A Latin motto—"Uniti Progrediamur" meaning "We go forward in Unity"

A second motto means "Union, Work, Justice"



The okoumé tree is symbolic of the timber trade

Two black panthers support the shield

The ship represents Gabon moving toward a brighter future